COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Head of AI at Infosys Limited Sees AI Agents Transforming Consulting With Automation and Efficiency

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SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The interview covered how a leading consulting and systems integration firm is impacted by and delivers AI agent solutions, including their use in regulatory compliance, pricing models, integration with partner technologies, and the anticipated future impact of AI on consulting delivery models.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Over 30 years of technical and business experience in the industry, currently leading the cloud and AI practice for a major consulting and systems integration firm across Europe and the Middle East, with extensive work for major global banks and financial institutions.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- **The expert is optimistic about the transformative impact of AI agents on consulting and delivery**, predicting a significant shift toward automation and efficiency, especially in roles involving manual or repetitive tasks.
- There is **a strong belief** that the adoption of AI agents will lead to a transition from revenue-based to margin-based business models, with a focus on domain expertise and niche services.

TAKEAWAYS

- The firm delivers AI agent solutions both as internal productivity tools and as client-facing accelerators, with a strong emphasis on explainable AI (XAI) to meet regulatory and audit requirements in financial services.
- Pricing models for AI agent projects include build-to-transfer, managed service, and SaaS, with **the majority of engagements being build-to-transfer or managed service, and SaaS adoption still limited due to client concerns over data security**.
- AI accelerators and agentic platforms are typically not sold as standalone products but are used to differentiate and accelerate service engagements; clients often receive perpetual licenses for these tools as part of transformation projects.
- The firm partners with major technology providers and resells their platforms (e.g., ServiceNow, UiPath, SAP, Oracle), sometimes pre-building AI agents for cloud marketplaces, but does not typically resell agents independently of the underlying technology.
- **The rise of AI agents is expected to significantly reduce the need for large delivery teams**, shifting the firm's operating model toward higher efficiency, deeper client relationships, and a greater focus on specialized domain knowledge.

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Table of Contents

Introduction and Expert Background

AI Platform and Regulation Challenges

AI in Consulting Services

Pricing Models and Client Savings

Build and Transfer Models

Infosys Topaz and AI Assets

Partnerships and Reselling Strategies

Support and Management Post-Implementation

SaaS Models and Future Directions

Industry Impact and Future Outlook

Expert Bio

Head Of Ai, Cloud Strategy And Sales, Emea at Infosys Limited. The expert is responsible for providing strategic guidance on AI and Cloud solutions for regional enterprise clients. Work horizontally across EMEA FS sales teams, delivering Cloud and AI transformations.

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Implement new Cloud Target Operating Models for enhanced business efficiency. Hold the Go-To-Market, Hyper-scaler Cloud, and AI execution and marketing strategies. Public speaker and Cloud & AI evangelist.

Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00

We will get started then. I will be leading this call today. Essentially, we are just trying to explore **how consulting companies, like yourself, are impacted by AI agents** and how you are delivering them to your clients. Before we get started, could you just share a bit more about your role at Infosys and your experience creating products related to AI agents?

Expert 00:00:19

Sure. I have over 30 years' experience in the industry, both technical and business related. I've been at Infosys for almost five years now. I have a Master's in AI. At the moment, I run the cloud and AI practice for Infosys across the whole of Europe, including the Middle East, for financial services. I pretty much work with every major bank in Europe and most of the global banks out of the U.S. as well.

Client 00:00:44

Thank you. You'd mentioned in our screening question that you have built an AI agent for BIS, who manages central banks. Can you just talk to us more about this exactly?

Expert 00:00:54

Sure. It's a twofold thing. It's actually leveraged off a set of products that we already have, which is called RAI, which is our regulation in AI platform. The thing that everybody is looking for is XAI, which is really, how do you explain the unexplainable? As financial service institutions start to move into the AI world, one big question happens around auditability. Every financial institution needs to be audited at some point, and part of that audit dictates that you have to show the workings of any sort of algo or AI agent.

Now, if you are using complex large language models, because they are based on neural technology and because they use dynamic data and they can change their inference based on the data that comes in and based on how long they have been trained on a particular subject, it becomes very, very difficult to audit these things and actually explain how they work. On top of that, we also now have the EU AI Act, which is a four-step risk model **which looks at unacceptable risk**, high risk, limited, and no risk.

You also have GDPR, which also covers part of risk and regulation in terms of how AI can use decision-making processes. What they are looking for was a system and platform which they could test the AI agents of all the financial institutions under their jurisdiction to try and explain and benchmark how those agents work, whether they were fair, whether they were open to bias, whether they were stable, whether they were robust, or whatever.

There are a couple of things that they looked at. One that they looked at was something called a feature attribution profile which looks at the variables which can change a model's decisioning making process. What weight does each variable have, and how does that variable change the model's outcome? We use something called a Shapley value or a gradient score to actually manage this. Shapley, in the AI world, it's a fairly well-known mathematical algorithm to test this type of weighting.

The other thing they looked at was fairness and bias. How does an AI act across different groups, whether they be a socio-economic group, whether they be a certain ethnicity? Does the AI contain some sort of bias from the data that treats different people differently? If that can be proved, then the bank itself could be open to litigation. Obviously, it's a fairly important thing.

One of the other key ones is around stability and drift. How does a model shift its inference after it's made a decision? If it makes a decision to give someone credit based on X score, will the next person along the line with the same X score get the same result, or will the model drift based on new information? Again, that tells you more about the fairness.

There's things like counterfactual sensitivity, which is how easily can an outcome be flipped by changing the inputs. If this variable was flipped, then you would get a loan. If it was flipped another way, you wouldn't get a loan. There are something around about 20 different factors like this that we put together to then test the validity, robustness, and the fairness of AI models, which then can be benchmarked and audited for auditing purposes.

Client 00:04:12

Got it. It seems like this was a platform to test AI products. Is the platform itself using AI?

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Expert 00:04:19

The EU AI Act can put massive fines on a company if **they misuse an AI**. This is an attempt by the central banks and the banks to give some sort of certainty and robustness on how the AI is used. Without having it, this actually fetters the distribution of AI. Nobody wants to use an AI in a key system if they feel as though they can't trust it and **they're open to litigation**.

Client 00:04:43

Right. My question is this platform itself, when the central bank uses it to test the validity of AI, is the platform itself built by AI or is that more rule-based? I think, in general, what we're looking for is your experience of implementing of AI or agentic platform. I think your example you provide tells us that this platform can test if an AI is valid, but then I'm unclear whether the platform itself is built with AI or agentic AI.

Expert 00:05:15

No. You basically use an LLM model to test other LLM models. You have to then train the model itself. What you have to do is use, what we call, a narrow transformer. It's a model with a very restricted view which works on certain individual parameters.

Client 00:05:32

Got it. We understand how this project came into place. Was the central bank coming to you with, "Okay, we need a specific tool," or was it more of an expert-led like, "We have this problem, Infosys, can you help us solve it?"

Expert 00:05:47

This is a fairly well-understood problem within the financial services market. Almost every major bank on the planet is looking at something called XAI, which is explainable artificial intelligence, because everybody is subject to regulation, whether it's Dodd-Frank, whether it's Sarbanes-Oxley, whether it's the SEC, whether it's the FCA, whatever, Basel, MiFID.

They all have elements within their regulation that say, "Okay, if you make a decision on something, you need to be able to explain those decision-making processes." You have to show that that decision was made in a fair and robust way. Not having something like this is really impeding the way AI is pushed out into the marketplace.

Client 00:06:31

Got it. Maybe let's shift gears a little bit. I want to hear more about, other than just this project, just your view on AI agents and your consulting services. Our observation is that, with the rise of agents, they can either be improving productivity internally with your consultants in terms of delivering a service to a client, or sometimes they get left behind as an asset or as an accelerator, and then the company ends up using the tool afterwards. Just curious, from the Infosys perspective, what's the percentage for each of them? Are you doing both? How does that look like?

Expert 00:07:07

We are certainly doing both. I think one use case that I can probably speak about is around technical debt simplification. I think this use case will probably explain both questions in one go. Technical debt simplification is an issue which is universal, across every enterprise, not just financial services. What it says is that you've got a bunch of old systems which are very brittle.

They probably don't have a lot of documentation, if any. Nobody really knows how they work because they were put in place 20 years ago, and they are costing a fortune to run and maintain. We can't change anything. People just build layers and layers of stuff on top of this old system until it becomes completely unmanageable. You see this a lot with mainframe-type technology. Mainframes are used today, everyone still sells them today.

Some of the old systems written in old versions of COBOL, people don't even have the documentation anymore. People don't even know how it works. There are less and less COBOL developers around. This is where you would use an agentic AI platform to do, what is known, reverse to forward engineering. Reverse engineering is a process where you can take something like source code and convert that into something which is human-readable in terms of documentation or business rules.

What you would do, once it's in a human understandable form, you would forward engineer that back into a more modern language, using modern coding practices, but using AI. The reason why you wouldn't translate one to another directly, line-by-line, is if you have an old piece of code which is written poorly, monolithically, and **it's in a poor state**, you will just end up with more code in a poor state.

If you can reduce it down to its basic business values and business rules, and then rebuild it from scratch, you actually get a much, much better outcome. There are like five different steps in this. One is code translation and rules extraction. This is where you reverse engineer, and different LLMs are actually better at doing this than others. For this, you might use something like Claude or Sonnet or something called Codestral or DeepSeek Coder.

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The next phase is to create that documentation. You take this, you put it against your source code, then you create documentation, and then you can use something like ChatGPT, which is very verbose in natural language processing, to actually create that. You can then augment this with RAG, which is Retrieval-Augmented Generation, which is maybe taking artifacts from either your CMDB or existing documentation to enrich it, and then you forward engineer it into the code that you want to do.

Again, you might use a different LLM like Mistral or Claude, and then you run it through an AI-based test harness as well, which will create the unit tests and run those for you in an automated work stream. Here's a way of using AI for operational efficiency. What we've seen is **they're about 400% more efficient than using coders**. If you can get this right, then they can do this to a speed and level of accuracy and a timeline that you couldn't get 100 developers to do, **which is pretty impressive**.

Client 00:10:24

That's like the making **your own team more productive side**, from the Infosys team?

Expert 00:10:28

Absolutely. What would have been done with 100 people, now you can do with a dozen. This is now the big shift in the marketplace, is using AI bots as developers. Instead of having POD-based agile delivery with human PODs, you now have POD-based agile delivery using AI agents.

Client 00:10:48

Are you passing on some of those savings to your clients?

Expert 00:10:51

Absolutely, because they demand it. Typically, now when we do a large transformation, say over three and five years, there's a discount variable applied across each year for automation. Also, because we have these new tools and we have these new AI agents and things like that, our customers are saying, "Well, okay. A lot of this stuff is automated. We don't want to be paying for 100 developers for three to five years or whatever."

Client 00:11:17

I just want to double-click on the pricing then. Now, you are charging less, but then are the companies paying for those AI tools?

Expert 00:11:24

Yeah. There are different ways to do it. Typically, large GSIs, like ourselves, like to do outcome-based pricing. We say, "Okay, you've got a mainframe, you've got 10 million lines of code on that mainframe, you want to convert it onto the cloud in Java. We'll do that for $20 million." It doesn't matter how many people we use, the risk is ours to deliver that in a certain timeline and whatever.

Customers are now much more savvy and they are saying, "You guys have got all these AI tools, it's only going to take you a year and a half to do this, and you are only going to be using like 20 or 30 people. We want that $20 million price tag to go down to $7 million or $8 million."

Client 00:12:10

What's that discussion like to figure out then what's the new price to charge?

Expert 00:12:14

Yeah. We do have some pricing models and matrixes that we can use to actually do that. We know, roughly, how many people would take what the AI accelerators will produce, as in terms of efficiency, over a period of time. We can put in also a risk factor. Everything has to have a risk buffer. We know what the consumption costs of the AI agents are. If you put those three things together, you can start to build an economic model.

Client 00:12:41

Is that shared directly with the clients or is it more so a back-end calculation and then you just share the final number with the client?

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Expert 00:12:49

You probably want to share a final number. You don't necessarily want to show all the workings because the thing is you have to buffer your price. The longer a project is, the more buffering you need to put in because that's more risk there is of something going left field in the project. If you're on fixed price or outcome-based pricing model, then you're actually on the hook. If **you hit something really horrible within a piece of code**, you still have to solve it somehow, and that can really derail your numbers. All that has to be taken into account.

Client 00:13:20

Yeah. Can you do if you're comfortable sharing with an example of a pricing model with AI agents. You don't have to tell us a client or anything, but just want to understand.

Expert 00:13:31

That's fine. There are three kind of pricing models that you can use. One is called a build-to-transfer model. You build the AI agents or the agentic framework within a company's enterprise, within a sandbox cloud environment, and you tailor it directly for what they're looking for. You tailor it to their specific needs and requirements.

The real advantage of this is that, one, you can pre-use white-labeled technology or language models, so there's no need to bring in an extra LLM from somewhere because otherwise you'd have to take this for all the security and CISO procedures, which can take up to six months for a large institution. **You can use existing licenses and tools for the development and control, so that again, brings down your total cost of ownership**.

You have far greater security and control over your security. You can use your standard active directory and things like role-based security and role-based access and secure VPNs, and you can also use existing firewalls and access control lists and cybersecurity software as well to control it. You have a lot more security control over it. An adjunct to this is that you can actually use these new AI frameworks in the cloud to offset a lot of your cloud consumption commits.

All the large institutions do the private pricing agreements with all the large hyperscalers, so they'll have one with AWS, they'll have one with Microsoft, they'll have one with GCP. Based on the number that they commit of how much workload they're going to put into that particular cloud, they get X amount of discount.

They can use a lot of this consumption, that happens in the cloud, to offset their number and actually get credits, and also hyperscaler funding as well, to move the workloads or create the workloads. I think the most important advantage is that they own the IP. The only downside is that they're responsible for its maintenance and operating cost and consumption costs.

Client 00:15:35

Sorry, before we go to the next model, so you build it for them, you white-label it, and then they own the IP. You don't necessarily provide a support and maintenance afterwards, is that correct?

Expert 00:15:46

This is the second model. One is that you just build it and give it to them, so "Here you go, it's all yours, you've signed off on it, you've done your tests, it's yours, you can do what you like with it." The next one is more of a build, operate, and manage as a managed service model. That's exactly the same as before, but now you have a management, and possibly a usage charge where you would charge them because you're running it as a service.

The management charge would be L1, L2, possibly L3 support. The usage charge is either they pay for the consumption, i.e. the tokens that they're consuming for the AI models, or you sell them blocks of discounted compute power, based on your relationship with that particular cloud provider. Does that make sense? Infosys is a huge consumption provider for AWS and Microsoft. We get discounts on our consumption cost because we drive a lot of revenue. We can then pass that through to our customers if we do a managed service.

The last one is a pure play SaaS model. Basically, it's a pure play SaaS model, people consume it as a service, and then you can either charge them on a usage basis, a subscription basis, you could use a tiered pricing model, or you can do an outcome-based or value model as well.

Client 00:17:06

Thanks for providing that overview. I think we just need a bit more clarification on the models. For the first one, which is the build-to-transfer model, so you build everything internally in Infosys and then you just transfer it to the client?

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Expert 00:17:21

No, not quite. We build it within their firewall. We build it within their premises. **I was just going to say the problem** is once you build something and then getting it over to them through the firewall, they have to then go through a bunch of regulations and CISO approvals and everything, so you actually build it in their environment. That gets rid of all that.

Client 00:17:43

They manage the updates and everything after it's done?

Expert 00:17:46

Yes. It's a completely fire-and-forget. You give it to them, it's theirs, have a nice life.

Client 00:17:52

Okay. How do you price for that? Is that based on how many people it takes?

Expert 00:17:57

Yeah, it's standard pricing model. Typically, we like to do outcome-based pricing models or we can do a T&M, time and materials.

Client 00:18:05

Got it. Can you just share, between the three models, what's the percentage of your projects that's in them?

Expert 00:18:12

Between one and two, I think would make at least 90% of all the models. I would say that one is probably around 60%, two is around 30%, and the very last model is about 10%.

Client 00:18:27

Do you expect this percentage base to change, where you're shifting more towards pure play SaaS, or do you expect this to stay?

Expert 00:18:33

I think that's a good question. I think even the ratios I've given you are probably out. I think SaaS models are only about 5%, if that. The other two make up 95%. I think as people get more used to SaaS models, especially for AI, that SaaS model will increase and the build-to-operate will decrease. **I think there's a lot of misgivings** still around data security, data leakage, and data contamination and toxicity.

Client 00:19:02

Can you just give an example of a SaaS? What are those Infosys SaaS that you would sell directly to your client?

Expert 00:19:08

For example, if we were to build a mortgages platform for somebody, you'd load up your data, apply for a mortgage, we'll give you a yes or no answer, and build a proper file about why it was a yes and no answer, and all the artifacts and everything else. This is why the pricing model for a SaaS model is outcome-based or value-based. You can do it per client process, for example.

Client 00:19:32

Okay. We've read online about Infosys Topaz, which is, I think, your agentic platform. How do you deliver that?

Expert 00:19:39

That's not strictly correct and that's probably our marketing team's fault. Topaz is actually an umbrella marketing term for around about 1,000 different assets that we have in AI and the agentic AI world. It's an umbrella name for all our AI assets. Within that, we've got about 1,000 assets, and they can be anything from a complete platform and framework to maybe a smaller subset of artifacts, or whatever, to train an AI or do some AI testing or whatever. Everything AI, that we build, that we own the IP for, goes under Topaz.

It's probably worth mentioning how that is actually brought to market. We don't sell AI products. We're a pure play systems integration and consultancy firm, so we don't really sell products. We build products, but we use them as accelerators within a services or transformation

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engagement.

Say for instance, you said to us, "Build us a KYC model," which we've done before. One of our big use cases is around KYC. We would have an agentic AI platform, which we would then use that as the base framework to build your KYC platform. We would only charge you for the time and materials or the services that we provide. We wouldn't actually charge you for the base platform. Having said that, we wouldn't sell you the base platform without those services. It's a differentiator in the marketplace for us.

Client 00:21:03

Okay. Just so I'm clear on your three pricing models you mentioned, how do you go to clients with it? Do you go with them with a product-first approach or is it more expertise-led?

Expert 00:21:14

It's use case-led. Always use case-led. **You've got a business problem**, your hair is on fire, you're bleeding money, you want it fixed. How do I fix it? We'll do something like an agile workshop or an experience workshop where we would storyboard everything out.

We'll build a backlog of features that you're looking for, and then we'll come back to you and say, "Okay, we think you should attempt it this way because this is what most people in the marketplace do," or "You should do it differently because your use case is very different, but we have these building blocks that we can assemble to help you get there faster." That's what Topaz is, a bunch of building blocks that we can assemble, that we can then accelerate the deliverance for.

Client 00:21:56

How common are using agents a part of the solution?

Expert 00:21:59

Now, we're mandated to use it everywhere. If you look in the press, a couple of years ago, Infosys announced this, an AI-first company. People question, "Well, what on earth does that mean?" About three, four years ago, we were almost 400,000 people globally. Now, we're down to about 340,000 globally. Now, we haven't sacked anybody. What's happened is, through natural attrition, wherever we can, we've actually replaced people with automation.

Client 00:22:29

For those agents or is it more so Infosys side pushing it?

Expert 00:22:32

It's both. One, as Americans would say, we drink our own Kool-Aid. If we don't do it, then there's no trust. Secondly, if you think about call centers now, the amount of people you have in call centers is dramatically slashed by using natural language processing bots, using agentic workflows, using AI-based document readers and transcribers. If you think about KYC onboarding for banks or any large financial institution, again, **the people element of this has been massively cut through automation**.

Client 00:23:03

I see. It seems like it's both the clients want it, there's an internal mandate. Therefore, a lot of your projects, you have it.

Expert 00:23:11

Exactly. If you think about it, the use case that I described about the technical debt simplification, where we would use, five or six years ago, 100 people, now we're using a couple of dozen. That makes a huge impact to the size of the company and our revenue and what our target operating model is.

Client 00:23:31

For those agents that you have, is it built on top of an existing technology or are you building them internally?

Expert 00:23:38

There are a couple of things. One, you probably want to build on existing technology. To create your own large language model, it is probably, I don't know the exact number, but I would say it's many tens of millions to build on.

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Client 00:23:52
We're talking specifically about Infosys, the technology that you're providing to your clients.

Expert 00:23:58
We would use a pre-existing language model and train it in a slightly different way because **the cost of creating a language model is prohibitive**. Having said that, I think we've built at least seven narrow transformers that we've actually embedded into some of our systems, like Finacle. We actually own Finacle, which is one of the world's largest core banking platforms.

Client 00:24:20
I see. At least what I've read online is Infosys is partnering with, I think, Google Cloud or to some of those agents. I also see, I think, Wipro also partnering with Google Cloud. Is there any differentiation when you're partnering with the same companies and then using their underlying technology to build some of those agents?

Expert 00:24:41
Yeah, because they do different tasks. The secret sauce is the business logic that you put into a language model, and the data that you train it on, and the framework you put it in. At the end of the day, what's the analogy I can use it, I'm trying to think of an analogy, you can give two different cooks the same ingredients and the same utensils, but they can come up with two total different dishes, completely taste different. That's the same thing with AI.

Client 00:25:10
Got it. Do you guys resell any AI agents or are they all built internally or on top of existing technology?

Expert 00:25:17
I don't think we've ever sold any agents. I don't think we want to sell an agent, quite honestly. I think we've built them for our own internal purposes, at least for the moment.

Typically, we will take an off-the-shelf set of LLMs like Sonnet, Claude, Anthropic, ChatGPT, OpenAI, whatever, and build a system around those rather than give you something from scratch because it costs hundreds of millions maybe to build a ChatGPT. It's just not something any GSI, I don't think, is looking to do.

Client 00:25:49
That makes sense. I'm more so wondering about the agent side. You're using these LLMs to train those agents which makes your project more productive. You don't actually resell any existing agents from the ISVs you work with?

Expert 00:26:03
We do. We have massive reseller agreements with people like UiPath, with ServiceNow, with SAP, Oracle, and they've all started to bring out their own agentic frameworks and their own AIs. For example, ServiceNow has its own AI Studio, it has its own bunch of AI agents which are pre-built that you can assemble and create your own workflows with.

They also have a marketplace where third parties can build AI agents and post them on the marketplace. What we did with Google is that we pre-built 200 AI agents and put it onto their Marketplace. You can download one of our AI agents from Google Marketplace and use it within your system.

Client 00:26:45
Can you just maybe give an example, either with UiPath or ServiceNow, Oracle, how does that come into place? Does the client come to you with a use case need, and then you figure out that reselling an SAP service or Oracle service is the best case forward?

Expert 00:27:01
If somebody says, "I've got three data centers, and I want to move them all to the cloud because I don't want to be managing all these data centers, they're costing me a fortune, and we're also running out of rack space and stuff like that." We then do an assessment of the existing infrastructure, the application landscape, and their technology stacks.

Based on that, we use, which is commonly known as a 7R approach to moving them to the cloud. One of those approaches would be

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repurchase. You may want to take an existing off-the-shelf product and repurchase a more cloud-native one. For example, MongoDB on-prem could go to MongoDB Atlas, which is the cloud-native version of it.

The other example would be something like, I don't know, Snowflake. You might have all these on-prem databases or something, why not move it to something like Snowflake or Databricks, which is much more cloud-native, or use something like PostgreSQL, which is a cloud-native service? This is why you would change the technologies and this is why you might move it to another one and this is why we resell a lot of technology as well.

Client 00:28:06

Okay. Are you also reselling agents specifically?

Expert 00:28:10

No, not really. If we resell a technology, then the agents are part of that technology. I think you can't really decouple the agent from the underlying technology unless you're talking about something like RPA, like UiPath, which are just agents that you put together. You can't really decouple a ServiceNow Agent from ServiceNow.

Client 00:28:31

Okay. Let's just take ServiceNow as an example. You're reselling them to your client. Who manages the support after the implementation? Is it Infosys or is it ServiceNow?

Expert 00:28:41

It can be either. It depends how the customer wants the contract. They could say, "Look, ServiceNow, we want to buy your software, we want to contract directly with you, but Infosys will be our implementation partner, and they will do the implementation."

They may even do the support for it like HelpDesk, or they might go directly to us and say, "Infosys, actually you're a reseller and we're a small company, and you get a much larger discount than we do because you're so much bigger and you sell tons of this stuff. We'll buy it from you if you give us a bigger discount than ServiceNow will give us." For that, you can also add in your services as well.

Client 00:29:18

Are there **any benefits for using Infosys versus a ServiceNow**, other than the cost?

Expert 00:29:24

Yeah, there are. It depends on the use case. Typically, something like ServiceNow doesn't exist in the vacuum. It's a product that supports other business functions. Wouldn't it be better just to have one throat to choke that does everything for you, including the transformation of those business functions as well as put it in the technology? Therefore, you have one person that really understands the entire business case and how to implement this within your environment, rather than trying to manage four or five different vendors.

Client 00:29:56

Got it. We're just going to go back to Topaz for a second here. Similar question on support and management. You're using Topaz's tools as part of their delivery, but do you also leave behind some of those Topaz tools with a client afterwards?

Expert 00:30:10

Yeah. You own the IP. We have a special kind of licensing agreement where you can use one of our tools in perpetuity. You even have the right to change it, but you don't have the right to resell it.

Client 00:30:22

Okay. What does the contract look like?

Expert 00:30:25

It's part of a transformation, as I said, we don't sell the tool individually.

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Client 00:30:29

After this transformation is done, do you charge extra for them to keep using it or is it already baked in in the original transformation?

Expert 00:30:37

It's already baked in. We don't actually charge for it. That's the thing. It becomes irrelevant in many ways. What we charge for is the service.

Client 00:30:47

Yeah. If a client continues to use it and **they have some issues with it** after the implementation is done, do you provide any support?

Expert 00:30:56

Yeah, we can do.

Client 00:30:57

Got it. You also mentioned the SaaS model. If you're not charging for Topaz, what are some examples of the SaaS model?

Expert 00:31:04

We have a company called Strata and we also have a product called Aster. Let's just go to Aster. Aster is a SaaS model that we've built and it's a multi-tenanted marketing engine. It uses high degrees of AI to do all the marketing for small and medium enterprises. That is a pure play SaaS model.

We would do either a usage-based contract with you, so how many functions you call, for example, or how many features you would pay for over a period of time. That would be a usage-based model, or you'd do a subscription-based model, i.e. you pay a flat rate and you can use X, Y and Z as much as you like, or we could do an outcome-based model as in how many tickets or cases we resolve or process, is what you pay for.

Client 00:31:53

I see. It seems like you have a couple tools that is in a SaaS model, but majority of your services are still use case-based, engagement-based and there are just instances where you will be using Topaz or any of your other asset accelerators.

Expert 00:32:10

SaaS models, especially for financial services, are still avoided by them because it's their data and they don't like to take their data outside their own perimeter.

Client 00:32:19

Is there a desire to sell any of like Topaz, for example, as a SaaS in the future?

Expert 00:32:24

Not that I know of. I don't know everything. I would say, not. The reason being is it's a great door opener for us. If we were starting to charge for Topaz tools, I think **we'd lose a lot of mind share** and thought leadership within the marketplace. I think the fact that **we can build these tools and use them accelerators and existing or new programs free of charge, is a very powerful thing**.

Client 00:32:51

Okay. From your knowledge, what are the other consulting firms doing in terms of providing AI agents? Are they charging for it or are they also offering as just part of service?

Expert 00:33:02

To my knowledge, I think Topaz is pretty unique-ish within the marketplace. We're a funny company in the sense that we're more of a delivery company than a pure play consultancy. If you look at a McKinsey, they're a pure play consultancy that have a very small delivery arm. Where we make our money is more around consulting for delivery.

The big dollars are in the delivery for us because we do very, very large deals. Doing a $100 million transformation for us is not uncommon. It would be very uncommon for McKinsey. Where they make their money is building architectures, North Star thought leadership papers.

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This is how you target operating models. This is how you do it. People then take that, and then put that out to tender to GSIs that have the delivery capability. We're much more focused on delivery than we are just on pure play consultancy.

Client 00:33:53

Yeah. Maybe then another example could be HCLTech or Accenture who does more of the delivery aspects. What are you seeing?

Expert 00:34:02

Yeah. TCS, Accenture, and maybe Wipro, they're all of a similar ilk.

Client 00:34:10

Yeah. Do **you see a lot of competition in providing those agentic technology** as part of their services as well?

Expert 00:34:16

Absolutely. It's the direction of travel of the entire world at the moment.

Client 00:34:21

What do you think about companies like Palantir, who is a software company, but it's going to market with, "Let me solve it for a problem"? Is **that a concern for you** as a threat and a competition?

Expert 00:34:33

Not really, no. Infosys has been around for 40 years, so they're pretty established within the marketplace, and lots of different business models will come and go, and lots of companies will come and go. The one thing about Infosys is that we are very deep within our relationships with our company.

Our revenues were just slightly under $20 billion last year and we've got about 1,800 clients. Now, if you look at other companies, maybe **their revenues are double, for example**, but they would have 4X the number of clients. What does that tell you? It tells you that actually we are very deep within our client base and **we're very sticky within our client base**.

Client 00:35:14

Okay. Just another question. You mentioned you integrate with a lot of different ISVs. I think, in a screening, you pretty much integrate with all of them. When you think about building your technology, other than using the open-source for a large language model, what companies do you work with, for what reason?

Expert 00:35:33

We choose the companies that we partner with based on capability and also market share. There could be companies that have incredible capability, but zero scale and very little market share. For us, they would be an edge case. We would go for the companies which are much more ubiquitous within the marketplace. That is everywhere. If our role is to integrate, then we are probably going to spend most of our time and effort and energy and money on integrating those things which are more widely spread.

We have a very large partner team that is dedicated to managing and curating partnerships with other technology providers and ISVs. We onboard them, we have training from them, and we actually set up specialist service lines which are dedicated to them, or we buy a company which is dedicated to them. For example, we have a company called Fluido, which are ServiceNow specialists.

Client 00:36:26

Got it. Last question for us is where do you see the future going in terms of how agents impact consulting? How will the rise of agentic platforms or agents impact companies like yours?

Expert 00:36:38

That'll hugely impact any company which has people heavily delivering roles. I think there's a tsunami-sized shift that will hit the marketplace over the next few years, and it's going to hit those companies which have a lot of people doing low- to mid-level manual tasks and even the higher end tasks as well, because they'll all be automated away. If you can think about people working in call centers, **they're going to be impacted massively**.

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You look at anyone that does any form of document inquiry or rationalization, like wealth managers, even solicitors and lawyers, **they're going to be massively impacted**, any companies that do lots of coding. I think it was Zuckerberg from Meta, last month, obviously announced lots of things that will never ever come true. He said, "The day of the programmer is dead. Who needs programmers? AI will do it all." Now, I don't necessarily believe what he said, but he's right in one thing. **It will massively disrupt the industry**.

Client 00:37:38

Does that just mean that Infosys will deliver the project with less people, going forward?

Expert 00:37:44

Yeah. It means we would deliver more projects and it means that we will probably move from a revenue-based company to a margin-based company, as the work we will do will be much more specific, much more niche, more along our domain knowledge where that becomes more important than actually the mechanics of delivering of a piece of code.

Client 00:38:04

Got it. Thank you so much for your time. Have a great day.

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